

SKILLS GUIDE



The ability to listen carefully and communicate clearly with both children and adults.



Good team-working skills to cooperate with teachers, social workers, and health professionals.



The ability to be sensitive and compassionate toward vulnerable and anxious patients.



Attention to detail for interpreting measurements to make a correct diagnosis.



Persistence, a good sense of humor, and the ability to motivate patients.



ADULT SPEECH PATHOLOGIST

Works with adults suffering from speech and communication problems that may have resulted from injury, stroke, cancer, or age-related disorders.



TEAM LEADER

Takes charge of the work and staffing of a unit, or joins a hospital's management team. This job requires work experience because it is a leadership role.



CLINICAL RESEARCHER

Conducts clinical trials on patients with the goal of improving medical procedures and clinical practices.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **PSYCHOLOGIST** *see p. 254–255*
- ▶ **PHYSICAL THERAPIST** *see pp. 288–289*
- ▶ **OCCUPATIONAL THERAPIST** *see pp. 292–293*
- ▶ **AUDIOLOGIST** Works with adults and children who experience disruptions to their hearing or loss of hearing, and balance problems.
- ▶ **ELOCUTION TUTOR** Provides lessons to help students improve aspects of their speech, such as pronunciation, diction, and voice projection.
- ▶ **NUTRITIONIST** Offers advice and information about healthy diets and lifestyles. Nutritionists can also conduct research and make recommendations to food companies and health care authorities.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Medicine • Biology • Psychology • Science • Health and social service • Social sciences • English • Languages • Linguistics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A master's degree and professional license are required to be able to practice as a speech pathologist.



LIFESTYLE Working hours are usually regular. Part-time work and freelance positions are also available, offering more flexibility.



LOCATION Pathologists work in schools, hospitals, community health centers, or assessment units. They may travel to work at different locations.



THE REALITIES Although patient expectations can be high and the work itself can be relentless and tiring, it is also extremely rewarding.